

edge healthcare technologies ranging from remote diagnostics to robotic surgery and preventive care.” EY recently deployed an AI/ML solution for a state government that would help it plan its resources efficiently in situations like the Covid-19 pandemic, including forecasting, demand estimation, day-level plan for the next 90 days, and scenario analysis.

Yet, there are miles to go. According to EY, 47 per cent of Indian healthcare organisations are still

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38 | studying AI for applicability, plausible use cases through proof of concept (PoC), and a clearly explainable RoI. “This implies a significant need for AI advocacy and RoI demonstration in a data-intensive sector that can profit enormously from a transition from mostly curative to AI-led preventive healthcare methods,” says Deshpande.

On the other hand, the PwC report suggests that one of the main reasons for not adopting AI/ML is the perception that automation will reduce job opportunities and result in job losses. India has a population of 1.4 billion and 522 million people are estimated to be employed all over the country. So, the perception of diminishing job opportunities is hindering the adoption of AI in India.

“It is a common assumption that technological advancement will threaten job opportunities and human efforts will be replaced by automation. However, the growing demand for digital healthcare solutions to make quality healthcare available to the masses has created opportunities in a variety of fields in India,” says Ganesh Lakshminarayanan, CEO at Airtel Enterprise Business.

With information technology enabling efficient management of the healthcare industry in areas such as statistical documentation, access to medical databases, and easier access to research on upcoming medical trends, Lakshminarayanan says employment opportunities have grown in tandem. “With the roll-out of 5G technologies, a 20 per cent increase in hiring is anticipated for positions such as networking engineers, experts in AI and ML, user experience designers, cloud computing experts, cybersecurity specialists, and experts in data science and data analytics,” he says.

Nothing artificial about this. **BT**

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Code Meets Cognition

AI IS PUSHING THE BOUNDARIES OF WHAT'S POSSIBLE, HELPING ITeS FIRMS PROVIDE SOLUTIONS TO BOTH CLIENTS' AND THEIR OWN PROBLEMS

BY **BINU PAUL**



IF THERE IS ONE INDUSTRY where AI is almost a natural fit for building competitive edge, it is IT-enabled services (ITeS). “Some of the popular use cases of AI in IT/ITeS industry are creating safer and better information systems to deal with the huge volumes of data, enhancing

customer experience by predicting market trends and customer behaviour, enabling process automation and efficiency analysis, simplifying IT operations management, managing huge complex data with MLOps, and more,” says Prashanth Kaddi, Partner at Deloitte India. “Exploring these use cases can provide a competitive edge to companies to stay ahead of the curve.”

At the same time, the spectre of job displacement